

Herald



Herald — cherald Flavor Guide (Operator)

Field	Value
Revision	1
Created	2026-05-30
Last modified	2026-05-30
Status	active
Status summary	Nano-detail operator reference for cherald (Constitution Herald) — the policy-evaluator flavor. Documents serve (the /v1/compliance HTTP plane) and the full §11.4 compliance-check command catalogue (creds-scan, docs-sync, composite-gate, export, catalogue-check, spec-version-check, readme-sync, fixed-align, fixed-summary-sync, script-docs-check, submanifest-verify). ANTI-BLUFF: derived from the built cherald binary (cherald --help, per-subcommand --help, version --json) + commons/branding.go. Most checks are DETECT-only and exit non-zero on breach; the mutating ones are explicitly flagged (--apply).
Issues	(none specific to this guide)
Continuation	Bump as new §11.4 doc-composite checks are added to the catalogue.

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§1. What cherald is

cherald is **Constitution Herald** — flavor key `C`, prefix `CHR`, default serving port **24792**. Per `commons/branding.go` its mission is "Policy evaluator + creds scan + docs sync + composite gate". It is the flavor that classifies a repository's state against the inherited Helix Constitution rules: each subcommand observes the tree (or a PR/diff), builds the relevant §-

Subject, classifies it through an HRD-019 binding, and **exits non-zero on a FAIL/breach verdict** so a CI gate can key off the exit code. Almost everything is **DETECT-only** — `cherald` mutates the tree only where an explicit `--apply` flag is passed.

Build it:

```
go build -o /tmp/cherald ./cherald/cmd/cherald
```

§2. The subcommand surface

Verbatim from `cherald --help`:

Subcommand	What it does	Mutates?
<code>serve</code>	Start the Constitution Herald HTTP server (<code>/v1/compliance</code>)	n/a
<code>creds-scan</code>	Scan for leaked-credential patterns; REDACT every finding (§16.2 → §11.4.10)	no
<code>docs-sync</code>	Check tracked <code>.md</code> docs carry §11.4.61 metadata + ToC (<code>--apply</code> regenerates siblings)	only with <code>--apply</code>
<code>composite-gate</code>	CM-DOCS-COMPOSITE-SYNC: aggregate the §11.4.60 doc-composite checks (detect-only)	no
<code>export</code>	(Re)generate <code>md</code> → <code>html/pdf/docx</code> siblings via the export script (§11.4.65)	yes
<code>catalogue-check</code>	Scan a PR description / diff for the §11.4.74 Catalogue-Check line	no
<code>spec-version-check</code>	Audit a spec doc's Revision header vs its git-modified state (§11.4.73)	no
<code>readme-sync</code>	Check README doc-link rows are in sync with on-disk docs (§11.4.59)	no
<code>fixed-align</code>	Reconcile <code>docs/Issues.md</code> [?] <code>docs/Fixed.md</code> for drift (detect-only; §11.4.53)	no
<code>fixed-summary-sync</code>	Check <code>docs/Fixed_Summary.md</code> parity vs <code>docs/Fixed.md</code> (§11.4.53)	no
<code>script-docs-check</code>	Audit that every <code>scripts/*.sh</code> carries a leading header docstring (§11.4.62 → §11.4.60)	no
<code>submanifest-verify</code>	Verify the §11.4.31 Submodule-Dependency-Manifest is present + well-formed	no
<code>version</code>	Print Constitution Herald version + build info	n/a
<code>completion</code>	Generate shell autocompletion (Cobra built-in)	n/a

Every classifying subcommand accepts `--emit` to also drive its verdict as a real constitution event, and (where it scopes a repo) `--repo string` (default: discovered from CWD).

§3. version

```
$ cherald version --json
{"arch":"arm64","binary":"cherald","build_time":"unknown","commit":"unknown",
  "dev"}
```

§4. serve — the compliance HTTP plane

`cherald serve` starts the Constitution Herald HTTP server. Per `docs/INTEGRATION.md` §10 it exposes `GET /v1/compliance`, returning paginated `constitution_state` rows (the audit trail of every policy decision). Default bind port 24792.

```
cherald serve --http-port 24792
```

§5. The compliance-check commands

`creds-scan`

Scans `--path` (default `--repo`) for leaked-credential patterns — AWS access keys (AKIA...), AWS_SECRET assignments, PEM private-key blocks, `password= / token=` assignments, Telegram bot tokens. **SECURITY:** every finding is reported with the secret value **REDACTED** — the actual secret is never printed. Classifies against §11.4.10 (a hit ⇒ FAIL). Exits non-zero on any hit. DETECT-only (never edits the scanned tree).

Flag	Meaning
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<code>--path string</code>	Explicit path to scan (file or dir); overrides <code>--repo</code>
<code>--repo string</code>	Repo dir to scan (default: discovered from CWD)

```
cherald creds-scan --path ./src || echo "LEAK DETECTED"
```

`docs-sync [<md>...]`

Checks the supplied (or all tracked) Markdown docs carry the required §11.4.61 metadata block (a Revision table row) + a ToC heading; exits non-zero when any doc is missing them. DETECT-only by default; `--apply` **additionally regenerates the HTML/PDF/DOCX siblings** via the resolved export script.

Flag	Meaning
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<code>--apply</code>	Regenerate HTML/PDF/DOCX siblings (mutation; default: detect-only)
<code>--script string</code>	Override the export-script path (default: <code>scripts/export_docs.sh</code> ; test seam)

`composite-gate`

The canonical CM-DOCS-COMPOSITE-SYNC entrypoint: aggregates three checks under one §11.4.60 verdict — (1) every tracked `.md` carries §11.4.61 metadata + ToC, (2) `README.md` doc-links all resolve on disk, (3) `docs/Fixed_Summary.md` is in parity with `docs/Fixed.md`. DETECT-only; exits non-zero when any constituent check is in breach.

`export [<md>...]`

Wraps the canonical doc-export script to regenerate HTML/PDF/DOCX siblings of the supplied docs (or every tracked doc when none given); exits non-zero when the export fails. The script is resolved from `--script` or `scripts/export_docs.sh` under `--repo` (§11.4.74 catalogue-first).

catalogue-check [<pr-ref>]

Observes a PR description (`--pr-body`, inline or `@file`) or a changed-files/diff list (`--diff-file`) and verifies it carries a `Catalogue-Check:` line (the §11.4.74 attestation). A trivial (empty) change is compliant; a non-trivial change with no line is a miss. Exits non-zero on a miss.

Flag	Meaning
<code>--pr-body string</code>	PR description (literal text, or <code>@path</code>)
<code>--diff-file string</code>	Path to a changed-files/diff list to scan instead of <code>--pr-body</code>

spec-version-check

Observes a spec doc (`--spec`, default `docs/specs/mvp/specification.V3.md`): whether its content was modified in the working tree without its `Revision` header bumped. Modified-but-unbumped $\Rightarrow$ §11.4.73 drift $\Rightarrow$ FAIL. DETECT-only; exits non-zero on drift.

Flag	Meaning
<code>--spec string</code>	Spec doc path relative to <code>--repo</code>
<code>--modified</code>	Force-treat the content as modified (test seam / non-git checkout)

The remaining detect-only checks

- `readme-sync` — checks README doc-link rows are in sync with on-disk docs (§11.4.59).
- `fixed-align` — reconciles `docs/Issues.md` [?] `docs/Fixed.md` for drift (§11.4.53).
- `fixed-summary-sync` — checks `docs/Fixed_Summary.md` parity vs `docs/Fixed.md` (§11.4.53).
- `script-docs-check` — audits that every `scripts/*.sh` carries a leading header docstring (§11.4.62 $\rightarrow$ §11.4.60).
- `submanifest-verify` — verifies the §11.4.31 Submodule-Dependency-Manifest is present + well-formed.

Each shares the `--repo` / `--emit` flag shape; run `cherald <command> --help` for the precise set.

§6. References

- Source: `cherald/cmd/cherald/main.go` + `docops_cmds.go`.
- Branding: `commons/branding.go` (flavor `c`).
- Integration: `docs/INTEGRATION.md` §10 (GET /v1/compliance).
- Constitution bindings: HRD-019 §11.4.10 / §11.4.53 / §11.4.59 / §11.4.60 / §11.4.61 / §11.4.62 / §11.4.65 / §11.4.73 / §11.4.74 / §11.4.31.
- Companion flavor guides: `docs/guides/{PHERALD, SHERALD, BHERALD, RHERALD, IHERALD, SCHERALD, QAHERALD}.md`.

Sources verified

Verified 2026-05-30: internal doc — no external online sources. Every subcommand, flag, default, and detect-vs-mutate claim above was derived by running the built `cherald` binary (`cherald --help`; `cherald serve|creds-scan|docs-sync|composite-gate|export|catalogue-check|spec-version-check --help`; `cherald version --json`) and reading `commons/branding.go` on 2026-05-30. No flags were invented. Re-verify whenever the `cherald` Cobra surface changes.